9th World Rogaining Championships 2010

Cheviot, New Zealand 20-21 November

Event Information – Bulletin 1

September 2009

The World Rogaining Championship is a single 24 hr event. There will not be a shorter associated event as we often have in New Zealand.

All communication will be in English.

Location

The event centre is located in Cheviot, a small rural town of about 400 people, 120 kms (allow 100 mins driving time) north of Christchurch city. A further 1000 people live in the surrounding area and villages serviced by the town. The competition area is all private farmland bounded by the Waiau River to the north, by the Pacific Ocean coast to the east, a range of rolling hills to the west, and the Blythe Valley to the south. Cheviot is slightly north of the centre of the proposed map and is 60 m above sea level.

Embargo: The area mentioned above and extending 12km to the west from State Highway One, except for public roads, is **embargoed** from now until the event. Any competitor violating this embargo will be disqualified from the event.

All of the usual access roads to Cheviot are sealed.

The facilities available in Cheviot reflect its role as a service town for the farming district and for highway traffic. In particular, there is a supermarket, hardware store, service station for fuel, and a few cafe/restaurants.

There is a range of accommodation available in the local area, in the surrounding districts, and in Christchurch. See the Travel and Accommodation section of the website for more information and suggestions.

Transport

The principal modes of transport will be by private or rental car, motorhome, or by the chartered bus provided from Christchurch. There is little public transport available. There is only one passenger train per day and it is a 4km walk from the railway station to the event centre. Intercity Coachlines run two bus services per day, one in the early morning and the other late afternoon, each way from Picton in the North and Christchurch in the South. These buses stop within 100m of the event centre.

Chartered bus transport is available from Christchurch on Friday afternoon and Saturday morning. Seats on the bus may be reserved at the Online Shop where details on departure times and fares are provided. Note that orders must be placed by 20th September.

For further information and suggestions on transport options see the Travel and Accommodation section of the website.

Terrain

Most of the terrain is open and fast, grassed farmland, with rolling hills and spur-gully features. A small amount of flat land lies west of Cheviot which is 60m above sea level. Coastal hills to the east rise to a maximum of 423 m on Mt. Beautiful. A number of 300 m saddles provide easier access to the coast, and south of Cheviot the hills are easier, rising to between 120 and 200 m. The hills to the west vary between 200 and 300 m.

The views from the coastal hills are spectacular, with the night lights of Christchurch visible across Pegasus Bay. Seals may also be seen on the coastal strip although the rocky shoreline and steep cliffs preclude travel along the sea shore itself. A number of minor roads and farm tracks exist, but for the most part travel will be cross-country rather than road or track walking.

There are a few pockets of native forest in the eastern streams, and some plantation forests. There is very little shrubby vegetation that cannot be negotiated. See some preliminary pictures; more will be posted as fieldwork progresses.

Map

The map will be prepared in OCAD and will be based on an available topographic data base augmented by on-site fieldwork. Map scale will be either 1:40,000 or 1:50,000. The size of the map will be notified later but is likely to be about A2. Contour interval will be 20 metres.

The mapping style to expect for WRC2010 is illustrated by this section of the map (500KB GIF) used for the New Zealand Championships 2009, although the WRC terrain is more gentle. Checkpoint locations will be pre-marked on the map as will out-of-bound areas. There will be a number of waterstations throughout the course. The map will be oriented to magnetic north and will have magnetic north lines overprinted.

It is unlikely that the map will be printed on waterproof paper so appropriate map protection will be necessary. Further information on this will be notified a month or two before the event.

Note that it will be necessary to use southern hemisphere compasses. Sources for the purchase of these will be advised a month or two before the event, if not earlier.

Scoring will be electronic using the Navlight scoring system (PDF version). There will be a wrist tag for each team member.

The total number of checkpoints and the maximum points that can be scored will be announced in the final event information. The value of each checkpoint will be the “tens” value of its number, so for example 37 is worth 30 points and 53 is worth 50 points. Checkpoints will be identified by a standard orienteering flag. They will not be reflective.

Model Course and other Exercise Opportunities

To familiarise competitors with terrain typical of that for the WRC a model course will be available a few days prior to the championship event. This will be about 90 km north of Christchurch in an area having very similar characteristics to the championship course. See the Activities and Tourism section of the WRC website for more information.

There are many other possibilities for exercise and training pre-event. Consult the Activities and Tourism section of the WRC website for suggestions.

Weather and astronomical

New Zealand weather is extremely changeable – commonly described as "four seasons in one day" – and can vary widely over seemingly short distances depending largely on the local topography. Expect November daytime temperatures in Cheviot to be in the range of 10° to 20° C, but the temperature could drop to 3° at night and could be up to 30° during the day. A frost is unlikely but possible. There is a 25% chance of more than 1mm of rain during the event.

Sunshine can be very hot, and the ultra-violet component of the sunshine is among the highest in the world. New Zealand sun will burn even on a cloudy day. Hats and sunscreen must be carried.

The following data has been extracted from the NIWA (National Institute of Water and Atmospheric Research) climate database:

November Statistics for Cheviot over 7 years

	Average	Maximum	Minimum
Total Rain (mm)	71.3	126.1	20.9
Wet Days (>1mm)	8	12	5
Max. 1-day rain (mm)	21	37.2	7.5
Mean daily max. temperature (°C)	19.1	21.5	16.2
Mean daily min. temperature (°C)	6.3	8.4	3.7
Extreme max. temperature (°C)	26.7	29	23.9
Extreme min. temperature (°C)	-0.1	1	-1.5

November total sunshine hours are available only for 2007 – 265 hrs

Statistics on the wind at Cheviot are not available. However, New Zealand is noted for strong and frequent winds which can be hot and dry or cold and wet. Be prepared for anything from calm conditions to winds averaging 50km/hr with gusts up 80km/hr.

The Sun and Moon times for Cheviot (longitude E173° 15´, latitude S42° 45´) are

Saturday 20th November 2010

Moonrise	19:12
Sunset	20:35
End civil twilight	21:08

Sunday 21st November 2010

Moonset	04:57
Begin civil twilight	05:17
Sunrise	05:50

The phase of the moon on 20th November 2010 is waxing gibbous with 97% of the Moon's visible disk illuminated. Full Moon is on 22nd November at 06:28.

Hazards and Safety

There are NO bears, snakes, mosquitoes, flies, tigers, jumping cactuses, or other nasties to spoil your fun or to demand caution. However, there are other hazards. New Zealand has strong health and safety legislation and both landowners and recreationists have responsibilities to minimise these hazards. Farm animals – sheep, cattle, and deer – will be encountered but present few problems as long as they are not crowded. Terrain hazards include rock bluffs, steep gullies, and partly collapsed minor erosion gullies that can catch a runner's leg. The event area has many barbed wire and electrified stock proof fences. Both types are safe to cross but require care.

One of the greatest hazards relates to New Zealand's changeable weather. Exposure to wind, cold and rain is a major cause of death in New Zealand's back country. Though this is particularly so in the mountains, it can also be a major risk in lower altitude hill country such as in this Rogaine area. New Zealand is an island in a big ocean, and is subject to strong and frequent winds, which can rapidly change direction, temperature, and wetness. With little natural bush shelter on the course competitors will need good rain-proof and thermal clothing if the weather turns bad. In contrast, sunshine can be very hot, and the ultra-violet component of the sunshine is among the highest in the world. Hats and sunscreen must be carried.

A safety plan will be in place for the event, and a qualified first aid team will be stationed at the hash house. Because serious injury may require a trip to hospital overseas competitors should ensure they have adequate medical insurance

Roads, including a national highway and a main trunk railway cross the event area. There will be strict rules in place governing how teams cross these. Any competitor crossing at other places, or travelling along the road or railway, will be disqualified.

We expect competitors to be responsible for their own safety. All participants will be required to sign an Indemnity Form which states:

> We, the undersigned, hereby acknowledge that the New Zealand Rogaining Association, the Event Organisers, and the owners of the land used for this event, accept no liability for any loss, damage or injury to ourselves (including vehicles at the event venue) resulting from our participation in this event. We enter this event at our own risk and acknowledge that there may be risks associated with the sport of Rogaining. We understand the safety requirements set out by the organisers and agree to abide by the New Zealand Rogaining Association Code of Conduct.

The Indemnity Form will be available on the WRC website closer to the event.

Hash house

The event is based at the Cheviot Area School where an area for tent camping will be available. Toilets and drinking water will be provided. Hot water, tea, and coffee will be available without charge from Friday evening until Sunday afternoon.

There is also a range of Motel, Hotel, Holiday home, and Farmstay accommodation in the area. For accommodation suggestions see Travel and Accommodation on the website. Fully self contained campervans (motorhomes) would be ideal accommodation.

Hashhouse food will be available to all competitors from 18:00 on Saturday and there will be an after-event meal for competitors and accompanying persons. The menu will be available on the

WRC website in the weeks leading up to the event.

Registration will be open on Friday evening and again on Saturday morning. A preliminary timetable is

Friday, 19th November 2010
- 17:00 Camping opens
- 18:00 – 21:00 Registration open
- 19:30 Meeting of the IRF Members and Observers
- 18:00 – 20:00 Evening meal available

Saturday, 20th November 2010
- 07:00 Registration reopens
- 09:00 Maps and associated information distributed
- 12:00 Start
- 18:00 Food is now available at the hash house

Sunday, 21st November 2010
- 12:00 Finish. Teams finishing after 12:30 are recorded as LATE
- 12:45 Deadline for submission of any protests
- 13:30 Results and presentation, catering at the hash house closes
- 14:30 Bus departs for Christchurch
- 21:00 Camping at the hash house closes

Tables and chairs will be available for course planning within the school gymnasium and classrooms but, depending on numbers, some people may have to plan elsewhere.

Storage for baggage, valuables and car keys will be available.

Entries
It is expected that entries will open on the 1st November, 2009. For team categories, entry criteria, entry procedures, fees and related information see the section labelled Registration on the website.

Apparel
A range of WRC2010 commemorative apparel is available for purchase via the Online Shop. Orders will remain open until 20th September.

Rules
The event will be run under the rules of the IRF modified with any specific departures that are necessary. The IRF rules are under review to accommodate electronic scoring, and maybe other issues, and are planned to be finalised mid-2010. The actual rules to be used will be available on the WRC website after the IRF review. The current rules (January, 2004) are available on the IRF website.

Results
Complete results and analysis will be published on the WRC website as soon after the event as is possible.

Enquiries
If you have any queries about any of the above information first check out the Forum in case someone else has had the same query. If you cannot find the answer there then post your enquiry on the Forum or email admin@wrc2010.org.nz .